Your 20-Minute Exploration, Grades 4–5

Start here

Choose one domain, try its activity as a learner, then plan how you will use it. Timing is advice; tick each activity you try.

One link opens the tour, the exploration, the lesson and the Site Guide: **The Language Page: Start Here** thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab/start

How to use each activity, and every activity on the site: **Activity Guide** /guides/activity-guide-4-5.pdf · **Site Directory** /guides/site-directory.pdf

The 20 minutes

0–2 min	**Choose one focus.** Listening, speaking, reading or writing.
2–9 min	**Try one activity.** Complete a short sample as a learner and try one support.
9–14 min	**Adapt it.** Fill in the planning card.
14–18 min	**Rehearse classroom use.** Explain it to a partner or rehearse your directions.
18–20 min	**Leave with one next step.** Activity, class, support, and when.

Web addresses below begin with thelanguagepage.com/access-practice-lab

Activity	What to try	One classroom use
Listening ☐ **Where Does the Book Go?** /Listening/A/g35-l-a-classroom-place	Press “Listen.” Try “Slower,” then “Hear question.” Choose an answer, say how sure you are, then press “Check my answer.”	Beginning of class: play one direction, students choose, then follow it in the room.
Speaking ☐ **Our Class Garden** /voice/ladder/class-garden	Press “Hear the question,” then “Hear Pablo first.” Say your own answer aloud. “Show a sentence frame” is there if you want it.	Partner warm-up: each student says the Step 1 answer to a partner, who listens for one detail.
Reading ☐ **Amara’s Garden** /Reading/A/g35-r-a-garden	Press “Read Passage Aloud,” then click one sentence to hear just that sentence. Try “Highlight” or “Pin evidence.”	Small group: read together, mark one piece of evidence, then answer.
Writing ☐ **Language Upgrade Lab: Plants** /scaffold/language-upgrade?item=lu35-explain-plants	Choose “Start with this help” (a frame and a word bank) or “On my own.” Write a better version of “Plants need stuff.”	Exit ticket: every student revises one sentence, then partners compare the exact word each chose.

Plan it

My students will practice... _____

Students will say or write... _____

I will offer this support... _____

I will look or listen for... _____

After feedback, students will try again by... _____

Say it to a partner: I will use ___ with ___ so students can ___. First, I will ___. Then students will ___.

Featured Lesson: Speak, Write, Improve

Our Class Garden, 10 minutes. Students will explain how the children help the plants grow and support it with a reason and an example, first aloud and then in writing.

> **Say to students:** “Look at the class garden. Explain how the children help the plants grow, and give a reason.” **Frame:** The children help the plants by ___. This helps because ___. For example, ___.

Open the lesson page	Open the activity	Site Guide
/start/lesson?grades=4-5	/voice/ladder/class-garden?grades=4-5	/site-guide

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1. **Notice** 1 minute. Show the picture. Ask: “What do you see? What are the children doing?” Take two quick answers.
2. **Speak** 2 minutes. Read the prompt. Partners take turns with the frame. For a model, the activity’s Step 3 · Tell more asks the same question and “Hear Tariq first” plays an answer.
3. **Write** 3 minutes. Students turn what they said into two or three written sentences. Allow home-language notes first.
4. **Improve** 2 minutes. Give one cue only: “Add an example that starts with For example.” Students add it and read the new version once.
5. **Share** 2 minutes. Two or three students read the revised response and say what they added.

Sample learner work

First response	Improved response
The children help the plants. They give them water.	The children help the plants by watering them and digging the soil. This helps because plants need water and soft soil to grow. For example, the girl waters the tomatoes with a watering can.

The improved response adds a clear action, a reason and an example.

One feedback cue	Add an example that starts with “For example.”
Quick check	Ask students to point to their action, their “because,” and their “For example.” Count how many have all three.
Follow-up	Students explain how the children could care for the sunflowers with the same three parts, then try the Language Upgrade Lab: Plants.

Three support choices Supports fade; the task stays the same.

More support
- Vocabulary: garden bed, tomatoes, sunflowers, watering can, shovel, soil, roots.
- Visual reference: the garden picture stays on screen.
- Oral rehearsal: say it twice with a partner before writing.
- Sentence frame: The children help the plants by ___. This helps because ___.

Some support
- Optional connectors: because, so, also, for example.
- Reason prompt: “Why does that help the plants?”

Greater independence
- Write a fuller explanation with two ways the children help.
- Choose a more exact word for “help” or “give.”
- Add what would happen without that care: “If ___, then ___.”

These are practical supports, not WIDA levels or alignments. Students may plan in their home language before they say or write in English.